

Website Audit

josephkerby.com · reviewed March 2026 · 19 findings

Everything below is something I verified directly against the files in the repo — page weights are measured, broken links were resolved against the filesystem, and contrast ratios were computed. Findings are ordered by how much they affect a real visitor.

To act on any of these, just reply with the IDs — for example “do C1, H1, H3”. I’ll open a separate PR for each batch.

CRITICAL — costs you real visitors

C1 The homepage downloads about 33 MB of images

The photo strip and the 20 mixtape covers are served at full original resolution — individual gallery photos run 2–3.3 MB each, and every album cover loads immediately on page load whether or not it is ever scrolled into view. On a typical phone connection this is a 20–40 second wait before the page settles, and it burns a meaningful chunk of a metered data plan. Resizing the photos to roughly 1600px wide, converting to WebP, and deferring the covers would cut this by well over 90% with no visible quality loss.

Measured: 25 MB photos + 7 MB album art · Impact: very high · Effort: medium

C2 The gallery page downloads about 27 MB

Same root cause, concentrated in one place: 13 photos at full camera resolution. The page does use lazy loading, which helps, but each individual image is still far larger than the 3-across grid it renders into — the browser downloads a multi-megapixel file and paints it at a few hundred pixels wide. Serving appropriately sized versions fixes this.

Measured: 26.6 MB across 13 images · Impact: very high · Effort: low

H1 The experience page has an outdated navbar with two dead links

experience.html was never updated when the navigation was simplified. It still shows the old Projects / Gallery / Experience / Tidbits tabs plus the mobile hamburger menu, and two of those tabs point at projects.html and tidbits.html — neither file exists, so both return a 404. Anyone who lands on this page sees a different site than the one they were just on.

Affects: experience.html (4 dead links) · Impact: high · Effort: very low

H2 The design resources page is unreachable

Nothing on the site links to design-resources.html. It is live and it is genuinely the strongest content you have — five real decks, competition results, a curated tool list — but the only way to reach it is to already know the URL. This is the page most worth showing to a recruiter or a competition organizer, and right now it is effectively invisible.

Affects: sitewide navigation · Impact: high · Effort: very low

H3 Links to your site have no preview when shared

None of the four pages carry Open Graph or Twitter Card tags. When the URL is pasted into iMessage, LinkedIn, Slack, or Discord, it renders as a bare blue link — no image, no title, no description. For a personal site whose whole job is being shared with people who might hire you, this is the single cheapest credibility win available.

Affects: all 4 pages · Impact: high · Effort: very low

H4 Homepage images all load at once

All 12 images in the homepage markup load eagerly — none carry loading="lazy", even though the photo strip sits well below the fold and most of it is off-screen horizontally. The gallery page already does this correctly, so it is just a matter of applying the same attribute here.

Affects: index.html (0 of 12 images deferred) · Impact: high · Effort: very low

M1 The homepage title is duplicated

The tag reads “Joseph Kerby — Joseph Kerby”. It shows up that way in browser tabs, bookmarks, and Google results. Something like “Joseph Kerby — Marketing student at UVM Grossman” would use that space to actually say something.

Affects: index.html · Impact: medium · Effort: very low

M2 The gallery page has no heading element

The visible “Gallery” text is styled as a plain div rather than an h1. Screen readers get no page heading to announce or navigate by, and search engines lose the strongest on-page signal about what the page is. The other three pages all do this correctly.

Affects: gallery.html · Impact: medium · Effort: very low

M3 Images have no dimensions, so the layout jumps while loading

Not one image on the homepage or gallery page declares width and height. The browser cannot reserve space before the file arrives, so content shifts down as each photo lands — the effect everyone recognizes as text moving out from under their thumb mid-scroll. Adding the intrinsic dimensions eliminates it entirely.

Affects: index.html, gallery.html · Impact: medium · Effort: low

M4 The design resources page embeds 24 MB of PDFs

All five decks are embedded as live iframes. They are lazy-loaded, which is the right call, but scrolling the page still pulls the full files — the BUS 1130 deck alone is 11 MB. A lightweight cover image that opens the PDF on click would keep the same browse-in-place feel at a fraction of the cost.

Measured: 24 MB across 5 PDFs · Impact: medium · Effort: medium

M5 No robots.txt, sitemap, or custom 404 page

Search engines have no sitemap to crawl, and any mistyped or stale URL — including the two dead links in H1 — drops the visitor on GitHub Pages' generic error page with no way back to your site.

Affects: site root · Impact: medium · Effort: low

M6

Roughly 8 MB of unused files are committed to the repo

assets/joe.jpg (6.5 MB) is an unreferenced duplicate of the avatar actually in use, and assets/msc/joe.jpeg is a second copy. KBPS.jpg, FECC.jpg, and website.jpg were orphaned when the projects section came off the homepage. Four variable font files are committed but never loaded — the site pulls those fonts from a CDN instead. Two empty placeholder files named “test” and “text” are also checked in.

Measured: ~8 MB removable · Impact: repo hygiene · Effort: very low

LOW — polish and maintainability

L1

The mixtape carousel auto-advances with no way to stop it

It rotates every 2.8 seconds indefinitely. There is no pause control, and unlike the flip badge — which correctly honors it — the carousel ignores the system “reduce motion” setting. That combination is a WCAG 2.2.2 failure and is genuinely uncomfortable for people with vestibular sensitivity. Dragging and scrolling already pause it temporarily, so the mechanism is half built.

Affects: index.html · Impact: low (high for affected users) · Effort: low

L2

The lightbox does not manage keyboard focus

Opening a photo leaves focus behind on the page, so a keyboard user tabs through the whole gallery underneath the overlay instead of through the lightbox controls, and focus is not returned to the thumbnail on close. Arrow-key and Escape handling are already in place, so this is the missing piece rather than a rebuild.

Affects: gallery.html · Impact: low · Effort: low

L3

The same 130 lines of CSS are copy-pasted into all four pages

Every page carries its own inline copy of the colour tokens, nav styles, and typography. Changing an accent colour means four separate edits kept manually in sync — and the drift has already started, since experience.html still contains hamburger styles the other pages have dropped. Pulling the shared block into one stylesheet would make future changes single-edit.

Affects: all 4 pages · Impact: low today, compounding · Effort: medium

L4 Tool logos are loaded from Google's favicon service

The nine icons on the design resources page are fetched live from `google.com/s2/favicons`. If that endpoint changes or is blocked, every icon disappears at once, and each request tells Google which page the visitor is on. Saving the nine SVGs locally removes both concerns and renders sharper.

Affects: `design-resources.html` (9 icons) · Impact: low · Effort: low

L5 The navigation may now be too sparse

Stripping the navbar to the logo and Email button gave the homepage a clean look, but it also left no path to the gallery or the design resources page. The homepage still links to the gallery inline, so that one is reachable — the design resources page is not. Worth deciding whether one or two links belong back in the bar, or whether inline entry points are enough.

Affects: sitewide · Impact: judgement call · Effort: very low

ALREADY SOLID — worth not breaking

OK What the site already gets right

Colour contrast passes WCAG AA everywhere I measured — the muted grey on the dark background is 7.76:1, the mint accent 15.34:1, and the purple 6.39:1, all comfortably above the 4.5:1 threshold. **The flip badge respects reduced-motion preferences.** **The visual system is genuinely consistent** — one palette, two typefaces, a repeating card and section-rule pattern that holds across every page. **Markup is semantic**, with real nav, section, and article elements and aria labels on the interactive regions. The coverflow supports mouse, touch, and trackpad. None of the issues above are structural; they are all additive fixes on a sound base.

Suggested order. C1 and C2 together are the single biggest improvement available and are mostly mechanical. H1 through H4 are all quick and remove things that are outright broken — that batch is probably an hour of work for a disproportionate payoff. Everything in MEDIUM and LOW is genuine polish that can wait for a rainy afternoon.